



(Don't Write anything in this Area)

3.b) Critically examine demographic and epidemiological consequences with rise in food production and sedentism. (15 marks)

Gordon Childe referred to discovery of agriculture by humankind 12,000 years ago as Neolithic revolution, indicating the drastic impacts it brought upon demography & epidemiological consequences.

Demographic changes

1) Increased food production & increased fertility

↑ Food production
& surplus

→

↑ consumption

↓

↑ fat composition
of women body

↓

↑ fertility

2) Increased population size: The population explosion across societies happened alongside

widespread prevalence of agriculture

⇒ Increased population density : Even the density increased as people were now forced to settle near river banks, channels, etc

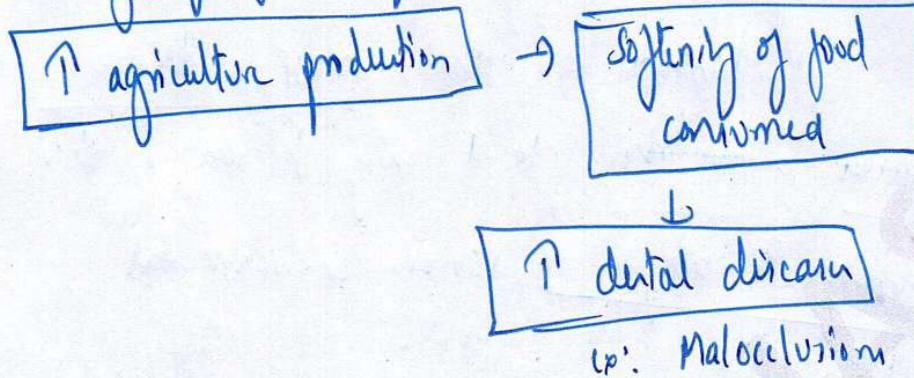
⇒ Decreased mortality : The life expectancy increased with better ability to fight infectious diseases with better immunity

⇒ Demographic transition : Current global community is ~~seen~~ witnessing decline in population especially in developed countries due to ~~higher~~ longer life expectancy & ~~lower~~ higher cost of living & hence decreased fecundity

Epidemiological consequences

4. The age before agriculture : Phase of famine & pestilence as the entire community would starve to death in absence of surplus food even scarcity

2) Age of food surplus :



3) Increase in lifestyle diseases : Sedentism & higher consumption of food over & beyond the ~~need~~ ^{demand} for physical activity has led to rise of diabetes, hypertension, etc

4) Lack of physical exercise - led to increased cholesterol level, obesity, etc that affects cardiovascular disease, pulmonary disease, etc

5) Rise in cancer - with increased chemical input of pesticides, fertilizers, etc on human body.

Therefore, although food production dynamically changed human polity & economy, etc, has also brought many diseases into play.